

# Physical - Non-Geostationary Satellite Model

As a kinesthetic learner, I learn by doing. That's why, for my project on Space-Based Solar Power, I started by building a physical model of a non-geostationary solar power satellite system. While some folks jump straight to the digital world, I personally needed to feel, explore, and tinker with the concept in real life before translating it into a CAD model.

## Building the Vision: My Physical Model

The physical model became a tangible representation of my vision for a future powered by clean, space-based energy. Here's what it looks like:

- **The Satellite:** The centrepiece is a satellite with large solar panels, crafted from cardboard, craft paper, glue, tape, aluminum wire and tin foil, to capture the sun's rays symbolically.
- **A Map of Connection:** The satellite hovers over a map of Canada. This map represents the potential for non-geostationary solar power to deliver clean energy across vast distances.
- **Reaching Diverse Locations:** Four key locations are marked on the map. These locations include bustling cities and remote areas, represented by red aluminum cord antennas. The antennas symbolize receiving stations that could tap into the beamed energy from the satellite.

## Why the Physical Model First?

As a kinesthetic learner, the physical model was an essential step in the creative process. Here's why:

- **Learning by Doing:** Building the model with my hands allowed me to grasp the scale and relationships between the different components of the system in a way a computer screen couldn't replicate.
- **Spatial Reasoning:** The physical model helped me develop a stronger understanding of the spatial relationships between the satellite, the map, and the receiving locations. This spatial awareness proved invaluable when I later translated the concept into a CAD model.
- **A Platform for Exploration:** The physical model was a playground for experimentation. I could adjust the positions of the components, try out different layouts for the receiving stations, and get a real-world feel for the possibilities.

## From Physical to Digital: The Power of the Blend

Once I had a strong foundation with the physical model, I moved on to creating a CAD model. The physical model provided a clear mental picture and a reference point as I built the digital

version. This combination of hands-on exploration and digital precision allowed me to develop a more nuanced and well-rounded representation of my vision.

This project perfectly exemplifies the power of combining kinesthetic learning with digital tools. By starting with the physical model, I laid the groundwork for a stronger and more meaningful digital representation. So, the next time you have a big idea, don't be afraid to get your hands dirty and build it first!